

SIKHISM CANON

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Abstract

Example

Contents

There is one formless, eternal creator. The Mool Mantar opens the Guru Granth Sahib with this declaration.

Example: Ik Onkar, Sat Naam, Karta Purakh, Nirbhau, Nirvair, Akal Murat, Ajuni, Saibhang, Gur Prasad One God, True Name, Creator Being, Without Fear, Without Hate, Timeless Form, Beyond Birth, Self-Existent, By Gurus Grace. This IS the D everything derives from these attributes.

2. Guru Granth Sahib as Living Guru

After the ten human Gurus, Guru Gobind Singh (1708) declared the scripture itself as eternal Guru.

Example: The Guru Granth Sahib is not merely a text it IS the Guru. It is installed on a throne (manji sahib) in every gurdwara, attended to, put to rest at night, awakened each morning. A book that IS a person = unique in world religion.

3. Ten Gurus (Temporal Chain)

Sikh revelation unfolds through ten human Gurus (1469-1708), each building on the previous.

Example: Guru Nanak (founder, 1469) Guru Gobind Singh (tenth, 1708). Each Guru added something: Guru Angad standardized Gurmukhi script, Guru Arjan compiled the Adi Granth, Guru Gobind Singh created the Khalsa. The temporal chain IS progressive revelation.

4. Khalsa (The Pure)

The Khalsa brotherhood, created by Guru Gobind Singh in 1699, defines the relational boundary of baptized Sikhs.

Example: Amrit Sanchar (baptism ceremony) initiates drink amrit from the same bowl, take the names Singh (lion) or Kaur (princess), adopt the

Five Ks (kesh, kangha, kara, kachera, kirpan).
The Khalsa IS the community boundary visible,
embodied, egalitarian.

5. Three Pillars of Practice

Naam Japna (meditation on Gods name), Kirat
Karni (honest work), Vand Chakna (sharing with
others).

Example: The langar (community kitchen) at every
gurdwara. Everyone sits on the floor, everyone
eats the same food, regardless of caste,
class, or creed. This IS operational governance
equality enforced through shared meals.

6. Akal Takht (Throne of the Timeless)

The supreme seat of Sikh temporal authority, es-
tablished by Guru Hargobind (sixth Guru).

Example: Five takhts (seats of authority) govern
Sikh institutions worldwide. The Jathedar of Akal
Takht can issue hukamnamas (edicts) binding on
the entire Khalsa. This IS structural governance
centralized temporal authority alongside the spir-
itual authority of the Guru Granth Sahib.

Constraints

MUST: Cite Guru Granth Sahib or historical Guru's teaching for claims
MUST: Distinguish Khalsa practice from Sahajdhari observance
MUST NOT: Subsume Sikh theology under Hindu or Islamic categories

SIKHISM / CANON / RELIGION